The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Excellent Door"

Āryasumukhanāmadhāraṇī · Toh 915 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་སུམུཁནཱམ་ཏ་ཧཱ་ར་ཎཱི་བ་ཀློག་ཏུ་གཞུག

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Excellent Door," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Sumukha Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Gozangpo Zhejawé Zung, is a short scripture centered on a dhāraṇī, a sacred formula of incantation believed to carry protective and spiritual power. It opens with the familiar words "Thus did I hear at one time" and is set at the foot of the Bodhi tree, at the great shrine of the seat of awakening. There the Buddha is joined by twelve hundred and fifty monks, including Śāradvatīputra and Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and by a gathering of bodhisattvas such as Vajrapāṇi, Vajradhvaja, Vajragarbha, and Maitreya, together with the other bodhisattvas of the Fortunate Eon. A bodhisattva then addresses the Blessed One, setting the stage for the teaching of the dhāraṇī. The work is Toh 915 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts gathered among the canon's collections of incantations.

In the language of India: ārya sumukhaṃ nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Excellent Door."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling at the foot of the Bodhi tree, at the great shrine of the seat of awakening. He was together with a great Saṅgha of monks, twelve hundred and fifty monks, among them the venerable Śāradvatīputra, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and all the other great śrāvakas. He was also together with a great Saṅgha of bodhisattvas, among them the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi, the bodhisattva great being Vajradhvaja, the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha, the bodhisattva great being Maitreya, and the other bodhisattva great beings of the Fortunate Eon.

Then the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, may the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Awakened Buddha please explain the Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, by which light will be brought to beings; by which they will be guarded, so that no adversaries or enemies can harm them, and will be protected; so that, that is, they will not be put in fear by the lords of the gods, the lords of the nāgas, the lords of the yakṣas, the lords of the rākṣasas, or the lords of the bhūtas; so that they will not be harmed by evil, by weapons, by poison, or by sorcery; and

so that, whether they are going out or coming back, lying down or asleep, mad or even utterly mad, they will be protected in every circumstance. For their sake, please explain such bases of secret mantra.

"I make this request of the Tathāgata so that I may always serve the Tathāgata, always guard and fully protect, and likewise for the benefit of all beings, and in order to guard and fully protect those sons or daughters of noble family who belong to the Bodhisattva Vehicle from quarrels, fault-finding, disputes, illness, and untimely death."

Then the Blessed One, understanding the request that the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi had made, said this to him: "Vajrapāṇi, excellent, excellent that you make this request of the Tathāgata for the benefit of all beings! Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, listen well and closely and keep it in mind, and I shall explain the Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door.

ugu mugu balini bandhani balacamana bahu bahu bahu libartāya svāhā"

He declared the bases of the dhāraṇī-mantra of empowerment from the crown of the Tathāgata's head. They will be upheld by the tathāgatas as well, and they will be blessed.

tadyathā vajrī vajrī vajrī vajrīdhari vajrāpāṇi vajrīdhari cakravajrī cakradhari paṭudhidhiri bhiri muri ciri ahuri bhaga bhibhiri śiritra śiri ruruce ruruce cari cari daricale curi muri paṇḍare

It destroys all evil, completely pacifies all diseases, and averts everything from untimely death up to bad dreams.

tadyathā bandhida gagariṇi murtani pramūrtani nāśani pranāśani

It completely pacifies disease and averts everything up to bad dreams, namely:

nāśāni nāśani bandhani bandhani cchindani cchindani cire mire mahehadani banibare khare bere biri biri bodhi bodhi suṣaṇi śaraṇi baru bariṇi barhūṃye prahmacāriṇi indrabati dhidhirīyaṇi namo maheśvarayani ṛśi bhañjani bābajahani kālapatini bhutabadani satyagathe somabādi somaprabhe svāhā

One will have a long life.

tadyathā hara hara hara hāni svāhā

tadyathā iḍitagaḍita badida ayena ari bañjani kakīrtani putradadahāni marga abhirohani husabati mupabadi hili hili yathā bajuya yathā agni yathā barancayathā nalaya yathā vajraṇa yathā hṛdaya svāhā

"Vajrapāṇi, this is the dhāraṇī called The Excellent Door, spoken for the benefit of beings out of the compassion of the tathāgatas. Just as the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas of the past spoke it and blessed it, and established it through their true commitment, so I too explain it."

Then from the tuft of hair between his brows, a mark of a great being, the Blessed One sent forth rays of light, and the radiance of those rays shone through all the buddhafields. Summoned by that radiance, the buddhas set out from their own buddhafields and came to this Sahā world. They gave their approval to the Blessed One Śākyamuni, saying "Excellent!" and declared: "Śākyamuni, excellent, excellent that for the benefit of all beings you have explained the Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, the bases of dhāraṇī-mantra that illuminate, that bring supreme joy, and that awaken mindfulness! We too shall bless it." And they gave their approval, saying "Excellent!"

"Whatever son or daughter of noble family holds these bases of dhāraṇī-mantra and recites them on rising in the morning should be known to gain twenty beneficial qualities. What are the twenty? They are these: that person will be blessed by all the buddhas; will be kept in mind by all the buddhas; will be free of every karmic obscuration that leads to the lower realms; will be long-lived; will live long and be renowned; will be endowed with wealth; endowed with strength; endowed with splendor; always endowed with good health; endowed with diligence; all the buddhas, the blessed ones, will be pleased with and know that person; all the gods will think of that person; that person will practice virtue; will strive earnestly toward virtuous aims; will become one who illuminates; will have supreme joy; will be endowed with mindfulness; will have perfect marks; will be fearless; and will be endowed with all the roots of virtue. Vajrapāṇi, these bases of dhāraṇī-mantra of the secret abode of the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, have been spoken and are blessed by all the buddhas."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I too shall teach bases of dhāraṇī-mantra in order to protect and guard that son or daughter of noble family. Whoever holds this vidyā-mantra that protects life, the Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, and recites it on rising in the morning, I shall protect from all harm.

tadyathā śikhi śikhi śikhi śika ci ci ci ci bha bha bha bha ru ru ru ru ji ji ji ji gra gra gra gra hri hri hri hri ha ha ha ha ma ma ma ma hana hana me sarva

pratyarthikā daha daha me sarva śatrava paca paca me sarva ahiteṣina svāhā"

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, saying "Excellent!": "Vajrapāṇi, excellent, excellent that for the sake of all sentient beings you have spoken the bases of dhāraṇī-mantra of supreme accomplishment!"

The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi said: "Blessed One, I shall teach a mantra by which I shall bestow every radiance into the pores of whoever holds this vidyā-mantra that protects life, the Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, and recites it on rising in the morning.

tadyathā hili mili cili svāhā prahma svare svāhā prahma avasugarbhe akalabe puṣa saṃstare svāhā

Venerable Blessed One, these are the bases of dhāraṇī-mantra for protecting and guarding the son or daughter of noble family who recites this on rising in the morning."

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too, through the blessing of the Buddha, shall teach bases of dhāraṇī-mantra in order to protect and guard the son or daughter of noble family who holds these vidyā-mantras that protect life and recites them on rising in the morning.

tadyathā bodhicitte paraṇi damāraṇḍe ditta tittitti gauri gandhari saramatanta vajratulani jvālamālalini cakrabāka śabare śabare śamare śamare svāhā"

Then the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, the Great King Dhṛtarāṣṭra, the Great King Virūḍhaka, and the Great King Virūpākṣa bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, we, the Four Great Kings, also shall recite this secret mantra of dhāraṇī in order to protect and guard the son or daughter of noble family who holds this vidyā-mantra that protects life, the Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, and recites it on rising in the morning.

tadyathā puṣpe supuṣpe bodhani saṃśodhani dhumaparihare āryapraśaste śānte niramukte maṅgalye hiraṇyagarbhe stare stapati svāhā"

Then Hārītī, the mother of the bhūtas, said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall recite bases of the secret mantra of dhāraṇī in order to protect and guard the son or daughter of noble family who holds this vidyā-mantra that protects life, the Dharma discourse of The Excellent Door,

recites it on rising in the morning, and keeps it in mind.

tadyathā pilisipa pili sili mahāpipili simelisi guruṇe guru guruṇe mahāguruṇe phu svāhā"

Then the great yakṣa general Pāñcika bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect the son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door and recites it on rising in the morning.

tadyathā aṭṭe phu baṭṭe phu naṭṭe phu kunaṭṭe phu manaṭṭe phu muṇḍa tahake phu śri phu bhaṃge phu maṃge phu svāhā"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect the son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door and recites it on rising in the morning. I shall guard them, uphold them, and shelter them; I shall bring them peace and well-being, ward off punishment, and neutralize poison. I shall seal the boundaries.

tadyathā hi vajre he vajre hī hā bisi bisi mahābisi phu svāhā"

Then the god Maheśvara (Śiva) said this to the Blessed One:

"Venerable Blessed One, I too shall recite these bases of the dhāraṇī-mantra in order to protect and guard any son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā hulu hulu hulu hulu lu sarva bhūta pratiṣedhanaṃ karomi svāhā"

Then the general Kumāra bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall recite these bases of the dhāraṇī-mantra in order to protect and guard any son or daughter of noble family who holds this pure Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā hili hili hili hili hili hili mili mili turu turu turu turu sarva bhūta pratiṣedhanaṃ karomi svāhā"

Then the god Candraprabha bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect and guard any son or daughter of noble family who holds this pure Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door and recites it upon rising in

the morning:

tadyathā aṃge vaṃge caṃge hini ḍi ḍi di di ci ci phu svāhā"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect and guard any son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, this life-preserving spell, and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā hate vihate nihate sarva pratyarīkā pratyā mitra śuddhe mukte vimukti vimale nirmale prabhasvare prabhakare phu svāhā"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Maitreya, said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect any son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, this life-preserving spell, and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā jvale jvale mahā jvale jvala jvaleni ukke mukke śame praśame mahā praśame śame samādhe mahā samādhe samā vadhe jvale mahā jvale jvala vame phu svāhā"

Then the yakṣa general Haimavata bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect and guard any son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, this life-preserving spell, and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā uduṃvare uduṃpe praduṃve vyāvarde ānaghe samādhe mahā samādhe nīle nīle nīla keśe keśeni kule kule mahā kule nīla kule siddhi siddhi manohare aṭṭe vaṭṭe naṭṭe kunaṭṭe samathe vavala kuce dānte nīla kaśe kule nīla dānte jāṃgule huśe mūśe valaṃ kuśe hala kuśe phala muce svāhā"

Then the great yakṣa general Sātāgiri bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect and guard any son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, this life-preserving spell, and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā amale vimale niramale maṃgale hiranyagarbhe sarva artha sādhani kamaścini yuvi raje kuṭa kuṭa kaṃvale prahma prahma svare prahma siddhe siddhi manorthe gu svāhā"

Then the great goddess Vajraśṛṅkhalā bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall recite these bases of the dhāraṇī-mantra in order to protect, defend, take hold of, and guard any son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, this life-preserving spell, and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā vajre vajre mahā vajre vajra dani buddha vajre buddha adhiṣṭhite vajre subuddhe nibuddhe vahu buddhe viśiṣṭa buddhe śuddhe buddhe buddhe nīśaṃgrāmaṇi jaṃgele alase tilime tile tilile marge śānta śānta gāmīni phu svāhā"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrasena, said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect any son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, this life-preserving spell, and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā hile vajre hehi vajre hehe vajra yava kiri kiri vajra svāhā

tadyathā aṇḍare paṇḍare śvete paṇḍara vasini kinnare karāde keyūre eha buddhe tatva buddhe bhūje bhūje bhūjaṃ game bhūja pāvate bhaye bhaye bhaya agra vate vinī vinī śira pathe śiva pathe āditya pathe teje teja vato ākāśa pathe phu svāhā"

Then Vajradūtī bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, I too shall protect, guard, and shelter any son or daughter of noble family who holds this Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, this life-preserving spell, and recites it upon rising in the morning:

tadyathā kuṭe kuṭe kuṭini kuṭa kuṭare svāhā nīli nīle nīlakeśe svāhā pīte pīte pītakeśe svāhā lohite lohite lohitakeśe svāhā avadāde avadāde avadātakeni svāhā mañjiṣṭhe mañjiṣṭhe mañjiṣṭhe keśe svāhā cakre cakre vajracakre svāhā

Then the Blessed One stretched out his golden-colored right hand and said "Excellent!" to Śakra (Indra), to Brahmā, and to all the world protectors: "Good sirs, through the blessing of the Tathāgata, you gods and world protectors have spoken well these foundations of dhāraṇī-mantra in order to benefit and protect all sentient beings. Excellent, excellent!"

Then the Blessed One also spoke to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, any son or daughter of good family who holds this life-preserving spell, the Dharma discourse called The Excellent Door, and recites it on rising in the morning, will

be blessed by all the buddhas. All the lords of the gods, the lords of the nāgas, the lords of the yakṣas, the lords of the asuras, the lords of the garuḍas, the lords of the kinnaras, and the lords of the mahoragas will keep that person in mind."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, Śakra, Brahmā, all the world protectors, that entire assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Excellent Door."

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and then revised and finalized according to the new standard terminology.

Translator's Notes

• The final paragraph does not name who comes from the other buddhafields. The honorific verbs and the context indicate the buddhas of those fields: they are summoned from their own buddhafields and then bless the dhāraṇī. They are named as such here. The title rendered "The Excellent Door" corresponds to Sanskrit Sumukha, "fair-faced" or "good opening."
• □□□□ in Vajrapāṇi's list of protections is taken in its ordinary sense of "punishment" (as in royal penalties), not the doctrinal sense "annihilation," since the context is worldly protection. □□□□□□□□ is read as the yakṣa general Pāñcika; the instrumental □ is fused to the name. □□□□□□□ (devaputra, "son of the gods") before Maheśvara is rendered simply as "the god."
• The general called "Youth" is taken as Kumāra (Skanda), the divine general. The yakṣa general "Dwelling on the Pleasant Mountain" is identified as Sātāgiri, the usual companion of Haimavata. In Vajradūtī's pledge, "shelter" renders sba ba, literally "to hide" or "conceal."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.